ANTIFAKE / EN

Complete AntiFake Toolkit

Eight chapters to check, understand and act

AntiFake
TOP MANTA

Contents

01 Who we are and why we created this toolkit 3

02 How to identify hate speech and racist narratives 25

03 How to detect false or misleading information 54

04 Putting AntiFake into practice 90

05 What can I do about racism and discrimination? 100

06 When forms of discrimination intersect 135

07 AntiFake glossary 145

08 Resources for verifying information 169

Who we are and why we created this toolkit



Before talking about disinformation, we want to explain where we speak from

Top Manta did not begin as a clothing brand.

To understand why we exist, we need to start much earlier and ask a question:

Why does a person leave their country, cross one of the world's most dangerous migration routes, arrive in Europe and end up selling goods on a blanket in the streets of Barcelona?

For a long time, other people told our story for us. They called us migrants, undocumented, illegal, street vendors. But behind each of these words are

Before talking about disinformation, we want to explain where we speak from

people who, before migrating, had a life, a family, a profession, knowledge, a community and plans for the future.

Migration is not the beginning of our story.

Before the border

The story of many of our colleagues at Top Manta begins in Senegal.

For many communities, the sea is not just a landscape. It is work, food, knowledge, identity and a way of life. When resources disappear or livelihoods deteriorate, migration can cease to be simply a choice.

A phrase that is part of our story explains it better:

“My dream was not to become a street vendor. I am a fisherman.”

This sentence asks us to look at migration

Before the border

differently.

Before asking “Why do they come?”, we can ask what happened before, what inequalities exist between territories, who benefits from resources, and what responsibilities global economic and political systems bear in migration processes.

Arriving does not mean having the same opportunities

Crossing a border does not mean that the obstacles are over.

When a person arrives in Europe, they may face new barriers: their immigration status, difficulty entering the formal labour market, racism, precarious living and working conditions, or difficulties accessing housing and building a stable life.

So when someone asks:

“Why do these people sell on the street?”

we suggest a different question:

“What real alternatives does a person have when

Arriving does not mean having the same opportunities

they cannot access the labour market on equal terms?”

The blanket was not our dream or our identity.

For many people, it was a way to survive exclusion.

From survival to collective organisation

But our story does not end with exclusion.

In 2015, Barcelona's street vendors began organising collectively through the Sindicat Popular de Venedors Ambulants, the Popular Union of Street Vendors.

Organising meant no longer facing collective problems individually.

We began speaking in our own voices, denouncing racism, defending our rights, demonstrating, supporting one another and building networks with other people, movements and organisations.

From survival to collective organisation

This also changed our position.

We no longer wanted migrants to appear only as people about whom others decide, legislate, report or speak.

We wanted to explain what was happening to us ourselves and take part in building solutions.

Top Manta grew out of this process of collective organisation.

Creating alternatives and changing the narrative

Top Manta was created to offer opportunities for dignified work, but also for another reason:

to change the narrative about street vendors, migrants and racialised people.

For years, others had constructed an image of us.

We decided to build our own.

Clothing, design, campaigns, social media, demonstrations and talks became tools to explain issues such as borders, racism, regularisation, rights, colonialism and dignity.

That is why, at Top Manta, a T-shirt is not just a

Creating alternatives and changing the narrative

T-shirt.

It can also be a way to tell a story, challenge an injustice and propose another way of looking at the world.

Messages such as MIGRATION IS NOT A CRIME challenge the criminalisation of migrants.

Other campaigns reclaim words, images and symbols that had been used to target us and turn them into tools for asserting our rights.

This is part of how we practise anti-racism.

Why create an AntiFake Toolkit?

The internet and social media have multiplied the amount of information we receive every day.

But they have also made it easier for rumours, false data, images taken out of context, generalisations and discriminatory speech to spread very quickly.

Migrants and racialised people frequently appear in these narratives.

Sometimes we are portrayed as a threat to jobs.

At other times, to safety.

To public services.

Why create an AntiFake Toolkit?

To culture.

Or simply as people who do not belong where they live.

Top Manta knows the consequences of these narratives because we have often been their targets.

But we have also learned something else:

we can produce our own narratives.

We can cross-check.

We can ask questions.

We can provide context.

Why create an AntiFake Toolkit?

We can explain what a news story, photograph or statistic leaves out.

And above all, we can listen to the people being discussed.

This is where the AntiFake Toolkit comes from.

We do not want to provide a list of answers to memorise.

We want to share tools so that anyone, especially young people, teachers, community organisations and communities, can ask questions about what they see, read or share.

Five questions to start with

This toolkit suggests a very simple way to approach information:

PAUSE

Do not share immediately.

LOOK

Who is telling this story?

CHECK

Where does the information come from, and what evidence do we have?

THINK

What are we being told, and what might be left out?

ACT

What can we do to stop false or discriminatory information from spreading?

These five actions, PAUSE, LOOK, CHECK, THINK and ACT, accompany us throughout the toolkit.

Because tackling disinformation does not only mean discovering whether a piece of data is false.

It also means learning to ask who constructs narratives, whose voices we hear, whose voices are left out, and what consequences the stories we share can have.

Telling our own story is also a form of anti-racism

Top Manta has moved from survival to collective organisation, from organisation to creating work and alternatives, and from our own experience to a wider struggle for rights and dignity.

We are collective organisation.

We are the social and solidarity economy.

We are dignified work.

We are regularisation.

We are design.

We are communication.

Telling our own story is also a form of anti-racism

We are culture.

And we are anti-racism.

This toolkit is part of that same journey.

Because when others have told the world who we are for so long, part of the anti-racist struggle is reclaiming the right to tell our own story.

How to identify hate speech and racist narratives

They are not always easy to recognise

When we think of racism or hate speech, we may imagine a direct insult, a threat or an openly racist expression.

But they do not always appear in this form.

They can also appear as a news story, a meme, a video, a statistic, a comment on social media or a claim that seems like “common sense”.

Expressions such as:

- “They take our jobs.”
- “They live off benefits.”

They are not always easy to recognise

- “They make our neighbourhoods unsafe.”

- “They do not want to integrate.”

may seem like individual opinions. But when repeated again and again, they help build a particular image of migrants.

That is why, in this toolkit, we do not only want to look at what a message says.

We also want to ask:

Who does it target?

Does it generalise?

They are not always easy to recognise

What emotions does it try to provoke?

What information does it use?

What story is it constructing about these people?

First: these are not all the same thing

Before continuing, it is important to distinguish some concepts.

A false or misleading rumour

This is false or misleading information that circulates as if it were true.

For example, a post claiming that a public benefit exists exclusively for migrants when that benefit does not exist on those terms.

A false rumour can contain racist content, but not all false rumours are racist.

A stereotype

This is an oversimplified idea that attributes the same characteristics to an entire group.

For example:

“Migrants do not want to integrate.”

People differ from one another. When we turn millions of people into a homogeneous group, we stop seeing their individual histories, circumstances and decisions.

A racist narrative

This goes beyond a single sentence.

It is a way of explaining reality that presents particular racialised groups or people of migrant origin as inferior, problematic, dangerous or less deserving of rights.

A narrative is constructed by repeating ideas, images, words and associations.

That is why it can continue to operate even when nobody uses an explicitly racist insult.

Hate speech

There is no single universal legal definition of hate speech. As a reference, the United Nations describes it as communication, whether spoken, written, visual or expressed through behaviour, that attacks or uses derogatory or discriminatory language against a person or group because of who they are, for example their origin, nationality, race, religion, gender or other identity factors.

Not every criticism, offensive opinion or piece of false information is therefore automatically hate speech.

The context and the way a group is targeted matter.

Five signs that can alert us

SIGN 1. It turns a group into “the problem”

Ask yourself:

Who is presented as responsible?

A message may discuss housing, jobs, safety, public services or living together.

The warning sign appears when complex social problems always end up having the same people to blame:

migrants, undocumented people, Muslim people, Black people, Roma people or other minoritised groups.

The problem stops being a specific situation and

SIGN 1. It turns a group into “the problem”

becomes who these people are.

SIGN 2. It constructs an “us” against a “them”

Pay attention to expressions such as:

- “People from here...”
- “Those people...”
- “Our own people first...”
- “We pay and they receive...”

These phrases construct a symbolic boundary.

There is an “us”, who supposedly belongs, and a “them”, who is portrayed as an outsider, even when those people live, work, study, have families and build community in the same place.

SIGN 2. It constructs an “us” against a “them”

Ask yourself:

Who can belong to the “us” in this message, and who is left out?

SIGN 3. It generalises

Imagine that a person commits a crime.

A news story highlights their origin.

The post is shared thousands of times.

Other similar cases again highlight the same origin.

Gradually, an association can be constructed:

a person of a particular origin is associated with crime.

But one person's behaviour does not allow us to explain the behaviour of an entire group.

We can therefore ask:

SIGN 3. It generalises

If this person were not a migrant or racialised, would their origin be equally important to explaining the news story?

And a second question:

Are we discussing a specific person, or is the message holding an entire group responsible?

SIGN 4. It uses fear

Fear is a very powerful tool.

Some messages present migrants as a threat:

- to jobs;
- to safety;
- to public services;
- to culture;
- to identity.

This does not mean that every debate about employment, safety or public services is racist.

The question is different:

SIGN 4. It uses fear

Are there data and context, or is a group being used to explain a complex problem?

When a post immediately makes us feel fear, anger, indignation or rejection, we have another reason not to share it automatically.

PAUSE.

We will check afterwards.

SIGN 5. It dehumanises

This is one of the signs that should concern us most.

It happens when we stop speaking about people and start speaking about them as a mass or a threat.

Words and metaphors such as:

- “invasion”;
- “avalanche”;
- “wave”

can turn people with different histories into a phenomenon that seems threatening.

Ask yourself:

SIGN 5. It dehumanises

Does this message allow me to see people, or does it only present a mass?

Dehumanisation creates distance. When we stop seeing another person as someone with a history, a family, rights and plans for their life, it becomes easier to accept treating them differently.

UNESCO emphasises that hate speech can target people for who they are and contribute to dehumanisation, intolerance and social division.

Narratives are built through repetition

An isolated phrase does not explain an entire narrative.

But imagine seeing, over several months:

- a news story associating migration with crime;
- a video about migrants and social benefits;
- a politician speaking of an “invasion”;
- a meme about foreign people who “do not want to work”;
- a comment claiming that “they do not want to integrate”.

Narratives are built through repetition

Each piece may seem independent.

But together, they can construct the same story:

“These people are a threat.”

This matters because disinformation does not only work by inventing data.

It can also work by selecting what we explain, what we repeat, what we leave out and which images we constantly associate with particular groups.

Educational materials are not neutral either: UNESCO warns that they can reproduce prejudices, stereotypes and particular views of the social order,

Narratives are built through repetition

which is why it recommends learning to identify these representations.

What if the information is true?

This is an important question.

Information can contain a true fact and still be explained in a way that leads us to a misleading conclusion.

We can ask:

Where does the data come from?

What period does it cover?

What is it being compared with?

What information is missing?

Why is people's origin highlighted?

What if the information is true?

Is a particular case being used to talk about an entire group?

Are we listening to the people the information discusses?

That is why AntiFake does not only ask:

“Is it true or false?”

It also asks:

“Do we have all the information we need to understand what is happening?”

A first AntiFake exercise

When you find a post about migration that provokes a strong reaction, do not yet try to prove whether it is true or false.

First, observe it.

LOOK

1. Who publishes it?

A person? A media outlet? A political party? An anonymous account?

2. Who is it about?

Does it concern a specific person or an entire group?

3. What words does it use?

Does it describe, generalise, ridicule, criminalise or dehumanise?

4. What emotion does it provoke in you?

Fear? Anger? Indignation? Rejection?

LOOK

5. What story is it constructing?

Are people shown as people with rights and their own voices, or only as a problem?

6. What might be left out?

Is there context you would need before reaching a conclusion?

We have not verified anything yet.

We will do that in the next chapter.

Because after PAUSING and LOOKING, it is time to:

CHECK.

LOOK

How do we know whether what we are seeing is true?

How to detect false or misleading information



Not everything that circulates is true

Every day, we receive a great deal of information.

It reaches us through Instagram, TikTok, WhatsApp, X, Facebook, YouTube, the media, family groups or conversations with other people.

Some information is true.

Some is false.

And much of it is harder to identify because it mixes accurate information with false data, removes an important part of the context or uses real images to tell a story that does not match what we are seeing.

Detecting a false rumour is therefore not about

Not everything that circulates is true

distrusting everything.

It is about learning to check before believing and sharing.

In the previous chapter, we learned to PAUSE and LOOK.

Now comes the third step in our AntiFake method:

CHECK.

First: what is a false rumour?

A false rumour is false or misleading information that circulates as if it were true.

It can take the form of:

- a news story;
- a video;
- a photograph;
- a screenshot;
- an audio recording;
- a chart or statistic;
- a meme;

First: what is a false rumour?

- a WhatsApp message;
- a social media post.

But one thing is important:

Information does not have to be completely false to mislead us.

A photograph can be real but have been taken in another country.

A piece of data can be correct but refer to a different year.

A video can be authentic but edited down.

First: what is a false rumour?

A news story can describe a real event but leave out information essential to understanding it.

A screenshot can look as though it comes from a news outlet but have been manipulated.

And today an image, voice or video can also have been generated or modified with artificial intelligence.

The European Commission warns about these forms of manipulation: altered visual content, information taken out of context, impersonation of legitimate sources and messages designed to provoke strong emotions.

Seven checks before sharing

1. Who publishes it?

The first question is very simple:

Who is giving me this information?

Data published by a public body is not the same as a screenshot with no identifiable origin.

Look for:

Who is the author?

Which media outlet, organisation or account publishes it?

Can we identify them?

Do they explain where they obtain their information?

1. Who publishes it?

If we cannot identify who is behind a piece of information, we should be more cautious.

Warning sign

“Someone sent it to me.”

“People are saying it on WhatsApp.”

“I saw it on TikTok.”

This explains where we encountered the information, but not where it comes from.

2. Find the original source

This is probably one of the most important tools in AntiFake.

Do not stop at the screenshot.

Do not stop at the headline.

Do not stop at the fifteen-second video.

Ask:

Where did this information originally come from?

If a post says:

“According to a study…”

find the study.

2. Find the original source

If it says:

“According to official data…”

find the official data.

If it claims:

“The government will introduce a new benefit…”

find the body responsible for that benefit.

If it quotes someone:

“X said…”

try to find the complete statement.

The original source lets us see something that often

2. Find the original source

disappears when information is shared many times: the context.

3. Check the date

A real news story from five years ago can become disinformation if it is shared today as though it has just happened.

Always check:

When was it published?

When did the events take place?

Which year does the data refer to?

Has anything changed since then?

This is especially important when we discuss migration, social benefits, legislation, regularisation or population data.

3. Check the date

Rules change.

Data change.

Context changes too.

Information that was true can stop describing the current situation accurately.

4. Look for other sources reporting the same thing

If information is important, we can probably find more information about it.

Do not simply look for another page repeating exactly the same text.

Look for sources that are independent of one another.

For example:

- public bodies;
- official statistics;
- media outlets with identifiable authors and editorial

4. Look for other sources reporting the same thing

standards;

- universities or research centres;

- specialist organisations;

- independent fact-checkers.

The European Commission recommends checking whether information is supported by several reliable sources and consulting fact-checkers when there are doubts.

But be careful:

Ten websites repeating the same information are

4. Look for other sources reporting the same thing

not necessarily ten sources.

They may all be copying a single false claim.

We need to find where the information comes from.

5. Do not stop at the headline

Headlines are designed to attract our attention.

Sometimes they greatly simplify information.

At other times, a screenshot shows only the headline and removes the rest of the story.

So:

Open the article.

Read beyond the headline.

Find the data supporting the claim.

Check whether the content really says the same thing as the headline.

5. Do not stop at the headline

And ask yourself:

What do I know after reading the full information that I did not know when I had only seen the headline?

6. Check photographs and videos

A real photograph can also lie.

Or, more precisely:

we can lie by using a real photograph.

Imagine a photograph of a large fight.

The photograph is authentic.

But it was taken in another country five years ago.

Someone publishes it today with the text:

“This is happening right now in Barcelona.”

The photograph has not been manipulated.

6. Check photographs and videos

What has been manipulated is the context.

Reverse image search is a very useful tool. It allows you to search for a photograph to check whether it has appeared on the internet before and in what context. UNESCO includes this technique among the tools for verifying visual content.

With a video, we can ask:

Who published it first?

When?

Where was it recorded?

6. Check photographs and videos

Is it complete, or are we only seeing a fragment?

Is there an earlier version?

Do other sources show the same event?

With content generated or manipulated using AI, we should not rely only on whether it “looks strange”. We should look for its provenance and confirmation from reliable sources. The European Commission includes deepfakes among the forms of manipulation we need to learn to recognise.

7. Pay attention to data and charts

Numbers can give us a sense of certainty.

But data need context.

Imagine reading:

“Crimes committed by foreigners have increased by 20%.”

Before reaching a conclusion, we need to ask:

Who published this data?

Which territory are we talking about?

Which period?

What exactly is being counted?

7. Pay attention to data and charts

Are we discussing reports, arrests, convictions or something else?

What are the absolute numbers?

What is it being compared with?

Has the population also changed during this period?

We are not saying that this particular claim is true or false.

We are doing something more important:

not reaching a conclusion until we have enough information to interpret the data.

When a news story confirms exactly what we already thought

There is another warning sign that is not on the screen.

It is in us.

We all have prior ideas about the world.

So when information confirms exactly something we already thought, we may feel less need to check it.

If we think that a particular group receives many benefits and a news story arrives confirming this, we may share it more quickly.

When a news story confirms exactly what we already thought

AntiFake suggests doing the opposite:

The more a piece of information confirms what I already thought, the more important it is to check it.

We do not only verify what seems absurd.

We must also verify what we would like to be true.

What if I cannot verify it?

Sometimes we will not find the answer.

We do not know where the photograph comes from.

We cannot find the study.

We cannot identify the author.

The sources contradict one another.

Or we simply do not have time to investigate.

In this situation, we can still make a responsible decision:

I do not know. So I will not share it as though I do.

Not sharing unverified information is also a way to

What if I cannot verify it?

slow disinformation. UNESCO recommends avoiding the reproduction of unverified content, and the European Commission advises against sharing when the origin or reliability of information cannot be established.

Let us try an example

Imagine receiving this WhatsApp message:

“NEW €600 BENEFIT FOR IMMIGRANTS. The media are not reporting it. Share before it gets deleted.”

We do not yet know whether it is true or false.

1. PAUSE

Do not forward it.

2. LOOK

Who sends it?

Is a responsible body identified?

Is there a link?

Is the message trying to create urgency?

3. CHECK

Search for the exact name of the benefit.

Consult the website of the administration supposedly providing it.

Check eligibility requirements and beneficiaries.

Look for a fact-check of the message.

Check the date.

4. THINK

Why does it say “for immigrants”?

Is it really a benefit available exclusively on the basis of origin?

Or are there financial, family, administrative or residency requirements that the message is hiding?

What narrative does this way of presenting the information construct?

5. ACT

If it is false, do not share it.

If someone sent it to you, you can explain what you found and provide the correct source.

The AntiFake questions

When you have doubts, remember:

WHO SAYS IT?

WHERE DOES IT COME FROM?

WHEN IS IT FROM?

WHO ELSE CONFIRMS IT?

WHAT MIGHT BE MISSING?

We do not need to become investigative journalists.

We need to develop a habit:

PAUSE before sharing and CHECK before accepting information as true.

Putting AntiFake into practice

A checklist for investigating any false or misleading claim

It is time to practise what we have learned. We can work with a news story, a video, a photograph, a social media post, a piece of data, a WhatsApp message or a claim suggested by an audience.

The aim is not to prove that information is false. It is to investigate it together and go as far as the evidence allows.

PAUSE

☐ What exactly is the claim we want to check?

☐ Do we have the original post, news story, video, image or data?

☐ Can we avoid deciding whether it is true or false before investigating?

LOOK

☐ Who publishes it or makes the claim?

☐ Who is it about?

☐ Does it concern one person, or does it generalise about an entire group?

☐ Does it use words or images that provoke fear, anger or rejection?

☐ Does it construct an “us” and a “them”?

☐ What story is it telling us? What might it be leaving out?

CHECK

☐ Can we find the original source?

☐ Does the person, body or media outlet presented as the source exist?

☐ What is the date of the information?

☐ If there is data, can we find where it comes from?

☐ Do other independent, reliable sources confirm the information?

☐ If there is a photograph or video, does it really correspond to the place, time and situation described?

☐ Do we have enough context to understand the

CHECK

information?

THINK

☐ What do we know now that we did not know at the beginning?

☐ Was important information missing?

☐ Is an individual case being turned into a claim about an entire group?

☐ Does the evidence really support the conclusion presented by the message?

☐ Has our opinion changed after checking the information?

ACT

Now we can ask:

What can we assert on the basis of the evidence we have found?

☐ TRUE: the available sources allow us to confirm the claim.

☐ FALSE: the available evidence contradicts it.

☐ MISLEADING / MISSING CONTEXT: it contains real information, but presents it selectively or out of context.

☐ GENERALISATION: it uses a case or a piece of data to attribute characteristics to an entire group.

ACT

☐ WE CANNOT VERIFY IT: we do not have enough evidence to reach a conclusion.

What do we do now?

☐ We do not share information we have checked and found to be false or misleading.

☐ If we share it to debunk it, we provide the source that allows it to be checked.

☐ If context is missing, we add it.

☐ If it affects a group, we also seek out that group's voices and perspectives.

☐ If we cannot verify it, we say so: “We do not have enough information to know.”

AntiFake does not give us the answer. It gives us a path for finding it.

What can I do about racism and discrimination?

What can I do about racism and discrimination?

Identifying racist speech, detecting false information and understanding how hate speech is constructed are important. But there comes a point when we need to go further:

What happens when racism affects us directly? What can we do?

Not all racist expressions or behaviours have the same legal consequences. A racist comment, discrimination in access to housing, a threat and public incitement to hatred are different situations and may require different responses.

What can I do about racism and discrimination?

This chapter offers some basic tools for understanding these differences, knowing when a situation may have legal consequences, what evidence is important to keep and where we can seek help.

This guide does not replace legal advice. In a specific situation, it is important to seek professional support or contact specialist services.

5.1. Are racism, discrimination and hate crime the same thing?

No. Although they are related, they are not the same thing.

Racism is an ideology based on the idea that some human groups, cultures or ethnic groups are superior to others. Legally, racism is not in itself a criminal offence. Certain behaviours motivated by racism can have legal consequences.

Discrimination occurs when a person receives unequal or unfavourable treatment on grounds such as racial or ethnic origin, nationality, religion or

5.1. Are racism, discrimination and hate crime the same thing?

other protected characteristics. It can occur, for example, in access to work, housing, a shop, a school or a public service.

Discrimination is not always a criminal offence, but that does not mean it has no consequences. Depending on the case, it can be reported and sanctioned through other routes, such as administrative proceedings.

A hate crime falls within criminal law. It may arise when certain criminal acts are linked to a

5.1. Are racism, discrimination and hate crime the same thing?

discriminatory motivation, or when conduct occurs that the Criminal Code specifically punishes, such as certain forms of public incitement to hatred, discrimination or violence.

There is another important point: racism can also aggravate another offence. For example, if an assault, threat or act of damage occurs and a racist motivation is established, that motivation may be treated as an aggravating circumstance.

Key point

Not every racist act is a hate crime. But the fact that conduct is not a criminal offence does not mean it is acceptable or that it cannot be reported or sanctioned through other routes.

Legal framework for section 5.1

Criminal Code, Codi Penal:

- Article 510 regulates certain behaviours related to public incitement to hatred, hostility, discrimination or violence, among other conduct.

- Article 22.4 provides for an aggravating circumstance when an offence is committed for racist, antisemitic or other discriminatory reasons provided for by law.

Other legislation against discrimination:

- Catalonia's Law 19/2020 on equal treatment and non-discrimination, Llei 19/2020, d’igualtat de tracte

Legal framework for section 5.1

i no-discriminació.

- Spain's Law 15/2022 on comprehensive equal treatment and non-discrimination, Llei 15/2022, integral per a la igualtat de tracte i la no-discriminació.

5.2. When can racist conduct have legal consequences?

Not all racist expressions have the same legal consequences. Context, seriousness, who the conduct targets, and what it causes or seeks to cause are important.

To understand this better, we can consider different situations:

Racist comments, jokes or expressions

A racist comment, an offensive joke or a generalisation about a group of people can be discriminatory and cause harm without necessarily constituting a criminal offence.

This does not mean it is unimportant. Depending on where it occurs and its consequences, it may give rise to other forms of reporting or action.

Discriminatory treatment

When racism becomes unequal treatment that restricts a person's rights, we may be facing discrimination.

For example:

- denying access to housing because of skin colour or origin;

- rejecting a person in a recruitment process for racist reasons;

- providing discriminatory treatment in a shop, school or public service.

These situations may have legal consequences even

Discriminatory treatment

when they are not criminal offences. In many cases, administrative routes exist for reporting them.

Threats, assaults or other offences with a racist motivation

If a person is threatened, assaulted or subjected to another offence and there is a racist or discriminatory motivation, that motivation may have consequences under criminal law.

When reporting, it is therefore important to explain not only what happened, but also any element that may show a racist motivation: words used, messages, symbols, previous comments or other circumstances.

Public incitement to hatred, discrimination or violence

Certain public behaviours may constitute a criminal offence when they promote or incite hatred, hostility, discrimination or violence against a person or group for racist or other discriminatory reasons provided for by law.

Certain public acts of humiliation or serious contempt against these groups may also have criminal consequences.

Key point

When faced with racist conduct, the question is not only “Is it a criminal offence or not?” A situation that does not reach the threshold of a criminal offence may still be discrimination, and another route may exist for reporting it or taking action.

Legal framework for section 5.2

Criminal Code:

- Article 510 covers different behaviours related to public incitement to hatred, hostility, discrimination or violence, and certain acts of humiliation or contempt on discriminatory grounds.

- Article 22.4 provides for an aggravating circumstance based on racist or other discriminatory motives in the commission of an offence.

- Depending on the conduct, other offences may also be relevant, such as threats, Articles 169 and 170, serious insults, Article 208, or degrading treatment,

Legal framework for section 5.2

Article 173.1.

Legislation on equal treatment and non-discrimination:

- Catalonia's Law 19/2020 on equal treatment and non-discrimination.

- Spain's Law 15/2022 on comprehensive equal treatment and non-discrimination.

5.3. What should I do if it happens to me?

If you experience or witness a racist or discriminatory situation, it is normal not to know how to react in the moment. You do not need to know from the outset whether what happened is discrimination, an administrative infringement or a criminal offence. What matters most is preserving information that may later help explain and substantiate the facts.

1. Keep the evidence

Keep anything that can show what happened:

- screenshots;
- messages, emails or audio recordings;
- photographs or videos you already hold legitimately;
- documents, advertisements or communications;
- the name or profile of the person or organisation involved;
- for online content, also save the link, URL, and, if possible, the date and time.

1. Keep the evidence

Do not delete the original messages or content, even if you have taken a screenshot.

2. Write down what happened

As soon as you can, write a brief account of the events: what happened, when, where, who was there and what was said or done.

If other people were present, also note who could be a witness.

This information may be important later, especially if you need to explain the events to a specialist service or make a formal report.

3. If it happens online, preserve the content before reporting it

For a racist social media post, comment or message, first keep the evidence. You can then use the platform's own tools to report the content.

This matters because content may be removed, making it harder to establish what was published.

4. Also explain why you believe there is a racist motivation

When seeking help or reporting events, try to explain not only what happened, but also any elements that may show a racist or discriminatory motivation.

For example: the words used, comments about your origin or skin colour, symbols, earlier messages or other circumstances related to the events.

Key point

You do not need to know which law has been broken before asking for help. Keep the evidence, document what happened and seek advice. The most appropriate route can then be assessed.

Legal framework for section 5.3

The Criminal Code, Catalonia's Law 19/2020 on equal treatment and non-discrimination, and Spain's Law 15/2022 on comprehensive equal treatment and non-discrimination.

5.4. Where can I seek help or make a report?

Not every situation should be reported in the same place. The appropriate route depends on what happened, how serious the events are and whether there is an immediate risk.

You do not need to decide on your own whether what you experienced is discrimination, an administrative infringement or a possible criminal offence. You can seek advice to help assess the case and decide on the most appropriate route.

If there are threats, assaults or signs of a possible criminal offence

You can make a report to the Mossos d’Esquadra or other police forces.

When explaining what happened, also mention any element that may show a racist or discriminatory motivation: insults related to origin or skin colour, expressions used, messages, symbols or other circumstances.

If you have experienced discrimination

Where there is discriminatory treatment that does not necessarily constitute a criminal offence, specialist routes also exist for obtaining advice and making a report.

In Catalonia, you can contact the Oficina d’Igualtat de Tracte i No-discriminació, the Office for Equal Treatment and Non-discrimination, which deals with discrimination linked, among other grounds, to racial or ethnic origin.

In Barcelona, you can also contact the Oficina per la No Discriminació, OND, a municipal service offering information, guidance and advice on discrimination.

Where can you find help?

- Oficina per la No Discriminació, OND, Barcelona: information, advice and support in situations of discrimination. Official information: https://guia.barcelona.cat/ca/detall/oficina-per-la-no-discriminacio_98348163616.html

- Institut de Drets Humans de Catalunya, IDHC, service guide: a directory of services and resources for advice and support in situations of discrimination and hate crime. Guide: https://www.idhc.org/es/publicaciones/servicios-de-entidades-y-administraciones-de-barcelona-para-victimas-de-delitos-de-odio/

If it happens online

After preserving the evidence, you can report the content on the platform itself.

If there are threats, incitement to violence, serious harassment or other acts that may constitute a criminal offence, reporting content to the platform does not replace the possibility of reporting the events to the authorities.

If there is immediate danger

If you or another person faces immediate risk or danger, call 112.

What if the person affected is a minor?

A minor can also disclose and report racism or discrimination. Their vulnerability and the specific circumstances of the case may also have particular legal relevance.

It is especially important that they can be supported by a trusted adult or a specialist service.

Key point

You do not need to know the correct route before asking for help. If you have doubts, seek advice, explain what happened and bring any evidence you have been able to keep. A specialist service can help you assess the next steps.

Legal framework for section 5.4

Equal treatment and non-discrimination:

- Catalonia's Law 19/2020 on equal treatment and non-discrimination.

- Spain's Law 15/2022 on comprehensive equal treatment and non-discrimination.

Criminal law:

- The Criminal Code, especially Article 510 concerning certain behaviours related to hatred, discrimination or violence, and Article 22.4 concerning aggravation based on discriminatory motivation.

When forms of discrimination intersect

Bringing an intersectional perspective to AntiFake

Discriminatory narratives do not always target people on the basis of a single characteristic.

Racism, sexism, LGTBI-phobia, Islamophobia, antigypsyism, ableism, immigration status and economic inequality can appear in the same narrative and reinforce one another.

Intersectionality helps us see these intersections.

It is a way of understanding that inequalities and discrimination relate to different dimensions of people's lives. When several of those dimensions intersect, they can produce specific and more

Bringing an intersectional perspective to AntiFake

intense forms of discrimination, exclusion or vulnerability.

This perspective also matters when we analyse disinformation.

When a false rumour activates more than one prejudice

False rumours and discriminatory narratives can be constructed using different prejudices at the same time.

A message can single out a person's origin and, at the same time, their religion.

It can use racist and sexist prejudices.

It can associate immigration status with poverty or criminality.

It can attack a person because of their sexual orientation while also using stereotypes linked to their origin.

When a false rumour activates more than one prejudice

These elements do not necessarily appear separately. They can form part of the same narrative and reinforce one another.

Bringing an intersectional perspective to AntiFake therefore means learning to identify which forms of discrimination are present in a message, how they intersect and what this intersection does to the representation of a person or group.

Words and images also construct these forms of discrimination

Intersectionality does not only help us observe who information discusses.

It also helps us examine how they are discussed.

Which characteristics are highlighted.

Which labels are used.

Which images are chosen.

Which behaviours are attributed to particular groups.

Whose voices appear as authoritative in explaining a

Words and images also construct these forms of discrimination

situation, and which people appear only as the subjects of a news story.

When different prejudices coincide in these representations, a narrative can reinforce more than one form of discrimination at the same time.

Recognising this helps us understand not only whether information is true or false, but also what view of people it is helping to construct.

One more layer for the AntiFake checklist

The intersectional perspective

When we identify potentially discriminatory elements in a message, we can add these questions to the AntiFake checklist:

☐ Which characteristics are being used to single out this person or group?

☐ Is more than one form of discrimination present in the same narrative?

☐ How do these forms of discrimination intersect and reinforce one another?

☐ What stereotypes are being associated with these characteristics?

The intersectional perspective

☐ Would the narrative affect or represent everyone in this group in the same way?

☐ Whose voices are telling the story, and which affected people are left out?

Looking from an intersectional perspective means broadening the question: not only who is being targeted, but why, through which forms of discrimination, and what happens when these forms of discrimination intersect.

AntiFake glossary

AntiFake glossary

Throughout this toolkit, we have used words that help us understand how disinformation and discriminatory narratives are constructed, circulate and can be analysed.

This glossary does not replace the explanations in earlier chapters. It is a quick reference tool for returning to a concept whenever we need it.

False or misleading rumour

False or misleading information that circulates as if it were true. It can be a news story, photograph, video, piece of data, screenshot, audio recording or social media post.

A false rumour can also mix true and false information or use real content out of context.

Disinformation

False, manipulated or misleading information that can alter how we understand a situation.

It can work by inventing information, but also by manipulating data, images or contexts, selecting only some of the facts, or presenting information in a way that leads us to an incorrect conclusion.

Source

The origin of the information we are consulting.

It can be a person, document, institution, research study, database, media outlet or any other place from which information comes.

Knowing the source helps us check it.

Original source

The place where information initially comes from.

If a post says “according to a study”, the study is the original source we will try to find. If it refers to official data, we will look for the body that published it.

Reaching the original source allows us to check what it really said and in what context.

Verification

The process of checking information before accepting it as true.

It can involve finding the original source, checking the date, comparing different sources, consulting data or checking the origin of a photograph or video.

This is what we do when AntiFake says:

CHECK.

Context

The information we need to understand a fact, figure, phrase, photograph or video correctly.

The place, date, circumstances, what happened before or what we are comparing data with can completely change how we interpret information.

Stereotype

An oversimplified idea that attributes the same characteristics to everyone in a group.

Stereotypes reduce people who differ from one another to a single image and can feed prejudice and discriminatory narratives.

Prejudice

A prior judgement or idea about a person or group that shapes how we perceive or treat them.

Prejudices may relate to origin, skin colour, gender, religion, sexual orientation, economic situation and many other characteristics.

Discriminatory narrative

A way of explaining reality that presents particular people or groups as inferior, problematic, dangerous, less capable or less deserving of rights.

It can be constructed through repeated words, images, stereotypes, associations and information that reinforce a particular view of a group.

Hate speech

Communication that attacks or uses derogatory or discriminatory language against a person or group because of identity-related characteristics such as origin, racialisation, religion, gender or sexual orientation, among others.

The context, intention, content and possible consequences of a message are important when analysing it.

Racism

A system of ideas, practices and inequalities that discriminates against, excludes or disadvantages people on grounds such as origin, skin colour or racialisation.

Racism can appear in individual behaviours, but also in speech, rules, institutions and social structures.

Racialisation

The process through which a society attributes meanings, stereotypes or characteristics to people or groups on the basis of features such as skin colour, origin, culture or religion, and treats them according to these categories.

Xenophobia

Rejection, hostility or prejudice towards people perceived as foreign or as coming from other countries or cultures.

Islamophobia

Prejudice, hostility, discrimination or hatred against Muslim people or people perceived as Muslim.

LGTBI-phobia

Rejection, discrimination, hostility or violence against lesbian, gay, bisexual, trans, intersex or other people because of their sexual orientation, gender identity or gender expression.

Antigypsyism

A specific form of racism, discrimination and prejudice directed against Roma people.

Ableism

Discrimination and inequality affecting disabled people, based on treating particular physical, sensory, intellectual or mental abilities as the norm.

Intersectionality

A perspective that helps us understand how different inequalities and forms of discrimination can intersect in the life of the same person.

In AntiFake, it allows us to observe which forms of discrimination appear in a narrative, how they relate and how their intersection can reinforce discrimination or vulnerability among those affected.

Generalisation

Moving from an individual case to a claim about an entire group.

For example, using one person's behaviour to attribute the same characteristic to everyone of the same origin, religion, gender or social group.

Dehumanisation

The process of representing people or groups in a way that erases their individuality, dignity or status as people with rights.

It can occur when a group is discussed as a mass, a threat or a problem, rather than as people with diverse histories and realities.

Discrimination

Unequal or harmful treatment of a person or group linked to characteristics such as origin, racialisation, gender, religion, sexual orientation, disability or other personal or social circumstances.

Pending legal concepts

The glossary remains to be completed with legal concepts once the legal information sheets have been validated by Isabel Carmona.

Resources for verifying information

Tools that can help us CHECK

In chapter 03, we learned how to verify information: find where it comes from, reach the original source, check the data, look at the date and context, compare it with other sources and check whether an image or video really corresponds to what we are being told.

But knowing what to check is only one part of the process.

We also need to know where to look and which tools can help.

Here we bring together useful resources for putting the CHECK step of the AntiFake checklist into

Tools that can help us CHECK

practice.

We do not need to use all of them. We choose the tool according to what we need to verify.

If we have an image

A photograph can be real and still be used to misinform.

It may have been taken in another country, belong to another period or have circulated years earlier in connection with a completely different event.

Google Lens allows us to search for an image or part of it and find visually similar images and related content online. This can help us discover whether a photograph has appeared before and in what context.

InVID-WeVerify is a more advanced verification tool. Among other functions, it allows reverse image

If we have an image

searches, video analysis and the extraction of frames to search for their origin.

It can be particularly useful when a video circulates on social media and we want to know whether the images are old, come from another place or have circulated before.

InVID-WeVerify.

Finding out whether a false rumour has already been checked

Before starting a verification from scratch, we can look for organisations that investigate different types of content, especially false rumours.

Verificat is a Catalan fact-checking platform that checks content circulating on social media. It provides fact-checks on different topics, including migration.

Maldita.es also verifies disinformation and publishes the sources and process it uses to reach its conclusions.

When a message uses figures or statistics

If we encounter phrases such as:

“The majority…”

“70%…”

“Every year…”

“The data show that…”

we can ask:

Where does this figure come from?

For Catalonia, consult Idescat, the Institut d’Estadística de Catalunya, the Statistical Institute of Catalonia.

When a message uses figures or statistics

For Spain, consult the Instituto Nacional de Estadística, INE, the National Statistics Institute.

AntiFake resources: quick reference

I need to find the origin or context of an image

I can use Google Lens to find visually similar images and related content, and investigate whether the image appeared before in another context.

I need to examine an image or video in more detail

I can use InVID-WeVerify to analyse images or videos and investigate the origin of video frames.

I need to know whether content has already been checked

I can consult Verificat or Maldita.es. These organisations specialise in investigating content circulating on social media and the wider web and identifying false or misleading claims.

I need to check statistics about Catalonia

I can consult Idescat, the Institut d’Estadística de Catalunya. It publishes official statistics on population, work, living conditions, the economy and many other areas.

I need to check statistics about Spain

I can consult INE, the Instituto Nacional de Estadística. It publishes statistics for Spain as a whole, including specific population statistics.

Remember: a tool does not think for us

Google Lens can help us find a photograph.

Idescat can give us a piece of data.

A fact-checker may have investigated a false rumour.

But no tool replaces our critical perspective.

We still need to ask where the information comes from, what the context is, whether the source is appropriate, what the data really says and whether what we found proves the message's claim.

That is why these tools do not replace the AntiFake checklist.

Remember: a tool does not think for us

They help us put it into practice.

Verification tools and sources change and evolve. This section will therefore be updated as we find new reliable sources, useful resources and verification tools that help us cross-check information better.

AntiFake is not a closed tool: it also learns, cross-checks and updates itself.

If we want to check information about racism, migration and borders

Not all the information we need to verify can be found in an official database or on a fact-checking platform.

When analysing information about racism, migration or borders, we can also consult specialist organisations that research, document and publish information on these realities.

SOS Racisme Catalunya publishes reports and data on racism and discrimination in Catalonia, drawing, among other sources, on cases collected by its

If we want to check information about racism, migration and borders

Servei d’Atenció i Denúncia, SAiD, the support and reporting service. Its materials can help us check information about racism, discrimination, hate speech and rights violations.

Caminando Fronteras researches and documents what happens along migration routes and at borders. Its reports and monitoring can be especially useful when we need to check information about migration routes, disappearances, deaths and violations of the right to life at borders.

One important point: no source can verify everything

A source can be highly reliable and still not be the appropriate source for answering a particular question.

If we want to check a population figure, we can look for an official statistical source.

If we want to know whether a photograph has circulated before, we can use a reverse image search tool.

If we want to investigate racism or discrimination, we can consult specialist organisations.

If we want to check information about deaths or

One important point: no source can verify everything

disappearances along a migration route, we need sources that investigate that specific reality.

Verification also means knowing which source we need to answer the question we are asking.